FAX COVER SHEET

Date: 03/12/2025
From: Three Rivers Spine & Orthopedics
To: Lodestar Claims Management - WC Intake
Number of pages (including cover): 14
Re: Okafor, WC-2025-PA-114209 - ortho records, MRI, EMG

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THREE RIVERS SPINE & ORTHOPEDICS | 300 Penn Center Blvd, Pittsburgh, PA

ORTHOPEDIC SPINE CONSULTATION

Patient: Daniel R. Okafor DOB: 07/11/1979 Claim #: WC-2025-PA-114209

Date of Service: 02/02/2025 Provider: Victoria Chen, MD - Orthopedic Spine Surgery

Reason for Consultation: Low back pain with right leg radiculopathy after work injury on 01/06/2025.

History of Injury: Twisting lift injury at Allegheny Freight & Logistics on 01/06/2025.

Symptoms: Low back pain 7/10 radiating to the right posterior thigh and lateral foot; numbness of the right small toe.

Prior Treatment: ED visit, primary care, cyclobenzaprine, naproxen and hydrocodone. No therapy yet.

Medical History: Type 2 diabetes. Former smoker. No prior lumbar injury.

Physical Exam: Straight leg raise positive on the right at 40 degrees. Diminished right Achilles reflex. Plantarflexion 5/5.

Imaging: Lumbar X-rays from 01/06/2025 reviewed: mild L5-S1 disc height loss.

Assessment: Lumbar radiculopathy, right S1 distribution (M54.16); suspected L5-S1 disc herniation.

Causation: Within a reasonable degree of medical certainty the condition is causally related to the 01/06/2025 work injury.

Plan: MRI lumbar spine without contrast. Physical therapy 2 times per week for 6 weeks (12 visits). Gabapentin 300 mg at bedtime.

Work Status: Modified duty - no lifting over 15 lb, no repetitive bending, no forklift operation.

Signed: Victoria Chen, MD 02/02/2025

(continued)

Review of Systems: Negative except as noted in the history of present illness.

Social History: Married, two children. Works full time as a dock loader/forklift operator.

Family History: Non-contributory.

Patient education provided; questions answered.

(continued)

Review of Systems: Negative except as noted in the history of present illness.

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Family History: Non-contributory.

Patient education provided; questions answered.

ALLEGHENY DIAGNOSTIC IMAGING | 1001 Liberty Ave, Pittsburgh, PA

MRI LUMBAR SPINE WITHOUT CONTRAST - RADIOLOGY REPORT

Patient: Daniel R. Okafor DOB: 07/11/1979 Claim #: WC-2025-PA-114209

Date of Service: 02/09/2025 Ordering Provider: Victoria Chen, MD - Orthopedic Spine Surgery

Technique: Multiplanar multisequence imaging without contrast.

Findings:

L3-L4: Mild disc bulge without stenosis.

L4-L5: Mild facet arthropathy.

L5-S1: Right paracentral disc protrusion contacting the descending right S1 nerve root; mild right foraminal narrowing.

Impression: Right paracentral L5-S1 disc protrusion contacting the right S1 nerve root.

Radiologist: Peter Novak, MD

Electronically signed: 02/09/2025

(continued)

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Family History: Non-contributory.

Patient education provided; questions answered.

THREE RIVERS SPINE & ORTHOPEDICS | 300 Penn Center Blvd, Pittsburgh, PA

ORTHOPEDIC FOLLOW-UP VISIT

Patient: Daniel R. Okafor DOB: 07/11/1979 Claim #: WC-2025-PA-114209

Date of Service: 02/23/2025 Provider: Victoria Chen, MD - Orthopedic Spine Surgery

Interval History: MRI 02/09/2025 reviewed with the patient. Attending physical therapy; partial benefit.

Symptoms: Pain 6/10 with intermittent right leg pain.

Physical Exam: Straight leg raise positive on the right at 50 degrees.

Imaging: MRI 02/09/2025 shows a right paracentral L5-S1 disc protrusion contacting the S1 root.

Assessment: Lumbar disc displacement with radiculopathy, L5-S1 (M51.17). Diagnosis updated from radiculopathy (M54.16).

Plan: Refer to pain management for epidural steroid injection. Continue physical therapy.

Work Status: Modified duty - no lifting over 15 lb; employer reports no modified duty available.

Employer Accommodation: Employer reports no modified duty available at this time.

Signed: Victoria Chen, MD 02/23/2025

(continued)

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Family History: Non-contributory.

Patient education provided; questions answered.

(continued)

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Family History: Non-contributory.

Patient education provided; questions answered.

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Signed: Victoria Chen, MD 02/02/2025

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Family History: Non-contributory.

Patient education provided; questions answered.

THREE RIVERS SPINE & ORTHOPEDICS | 300 Penn Center Blvd, Pittsburgh, PA

ELECTRODIAGNOSTIC STUDY (EMG/NCS) REPORT

Patient: Daniel R. Okafor DOB: 07/11/1979 Claim #: WC-2025-PA-114209

Date of Service: 03/09/2025 Provider: Samuel Ortiz, MD - Physical Medicine and Rehabilitation
Findings: Mild chronic right S1 radiculopathy without active denervation. No peripheral neuropathy.
Impression: Electrodiagnostic evidence of a mild chronic right S1 radiculopathy.
Signed: Samuel Ortiz, MD

(continued)

Review of Systems: Negative except as noted in the history of present illness.

Social History: Married, two children. Works full time as a dock loader/forklift operator.

Family History: Non-contributory.

Patient education provided; questions answered.